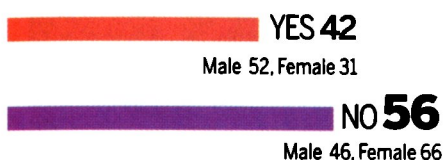
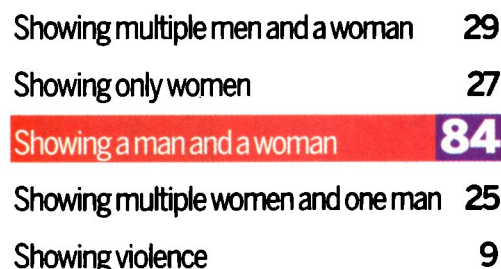


Have you ever fantasised about watching porn with your partner?



Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.

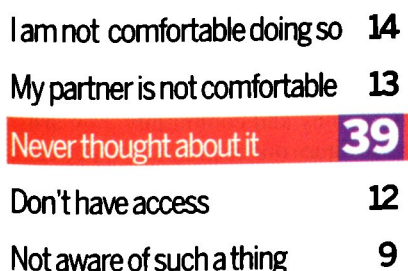
What kind of porn would you want to watch?



For 2,235 respondents of the total 5,371 who want to watch porn with their partners. Figures add up to more than 100 because of multiple choices. All figures in per cent.

18 PER CENT MEN ARE INTERESTED IN WATCHING PORN SHOWING ONLY MALES. JAIPUR TOPS THE CHART WITH 54 PER CENT EXPRESSING SAME DESIRE.

Why haven't you ever tried watching porn with your partner?



For 2,330 respondents of the total 5,371 who have not watched porn with their partners. Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.

possibly titillate like the rooftop scene in *Raja Babu*, where Karisma Kapoor and Govinda simulate every conceivable position to the tune of a very suggestive *sarkaye leo khatiya*. It had a very satisfied and vocal third-tier audience, just that it was not labelled pornography. And those who watched and derived pleasure from it did not have to make any overt admission to having done so.

Perhaps, that is really what the basic contention with pornography is. When something carries the label 'pornography', it is an open admission that it aims to incite sexual responsiveness. And therefore, to admit watching pornography in any form is an open admission to permitting oneself the pleasure from such stimulation. What is puzzling, however, is why it should be shameful for even a married couple in India to derive sexual pleasure from indulgence in a bit of visual sensory stimulation now and then? Therapists nowadays often recommend that couples watch porn films together to put a little zing into their flagging sex lives, and revive intimacy. Yet 46 per cent of married men and 64 per cent of married women say they would not want to see porn films with their partner. While it is all right for the married to reproduce in India, it is indecent for them to admit to indulgence in sex for pleasure.

Indeed, the father of our nation was vociferously opposed to married couples having sex for pleasure. Mahatma Gandhi declared the sole purpose of sex was reproduction. And if couples intended not to make babies, then they shouldn't even be sleeping together. He believed that all women who used contraception were whores because they were having sex not for reproduction, but pleasure. He had no equivalent label for men who did the same. Perhaps, it is this tacit permissiveness towards men that allows for far more men than women to admit watching or desiring to watch porn films as is evident in this survey.

It is a pity though that modern India does not seek its sex education from the gurus who preceded Mahatma Gandhi by about 1,500 years, and not only wrote mammoth anthologies on sex but were so versatile in their knowledge of it that they were bestowed with the title of *acharya*. It would have solved many of our current sex-related problems, including overpopulation and squeamishness about porn. India's ancient sexologists proclaimed that sex solely for the purpose of reproduction is what animals do. For humans, the aim is pleasure. And they asserted this applied to women as well. This pleasure was to be attained through the stimulation of each of our senses—sight, sound, touch, taste, and smell, as well as intuition and balance was expounded on in the *Kama Sutra*s. The 64 art forms including music, dancing, cookery, perfumery, riding, dressmaking among others that one was expected to master as an integral aspect of learning the art of love-making (*kamashashtra*), were in essence an exercise in honing the sensory organs. It is a wisdom which the Western world perhaps comprehends and embraces more fully than India does. The idea behind